

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

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Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimizing manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilization within the IT department by optimizing task allocation.
Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone1: Flow

Activity 1:

Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All>> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “System user” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.

Flow

FAVORITES

No Results

ALL RESULTS

✓ Docker Webhook Answer Subf...

Docker Webhook Answer Subf...

Webhook Answer Subflow

✓ Process Automation Flow & Action Designer

Flow Designer ↗



✓ Flow Administration

servicenow Flow Designer

Flows Subflows Actions Executions Connections Help

New ▾

Flow
Subflow
Action
Data Stream

Search Updated ▾ Search

All

	Name	Internal name	Application	Status	Active	Updated ▾	Updated by
☐	Standard Laptop task	standard_laptop_task	Global	Published	true	2024-04-16 23:33:53	admin
☐	Email Sending For P1	email_sending_for_p1	Global	Published	false	2024-04-16 04:22:31	admin
☐	Daily Task Reminder	daily_task_reminder	Global	Draft	false	2024-04-16 00:08:03	admin

Flow properties

* Flow name

Description

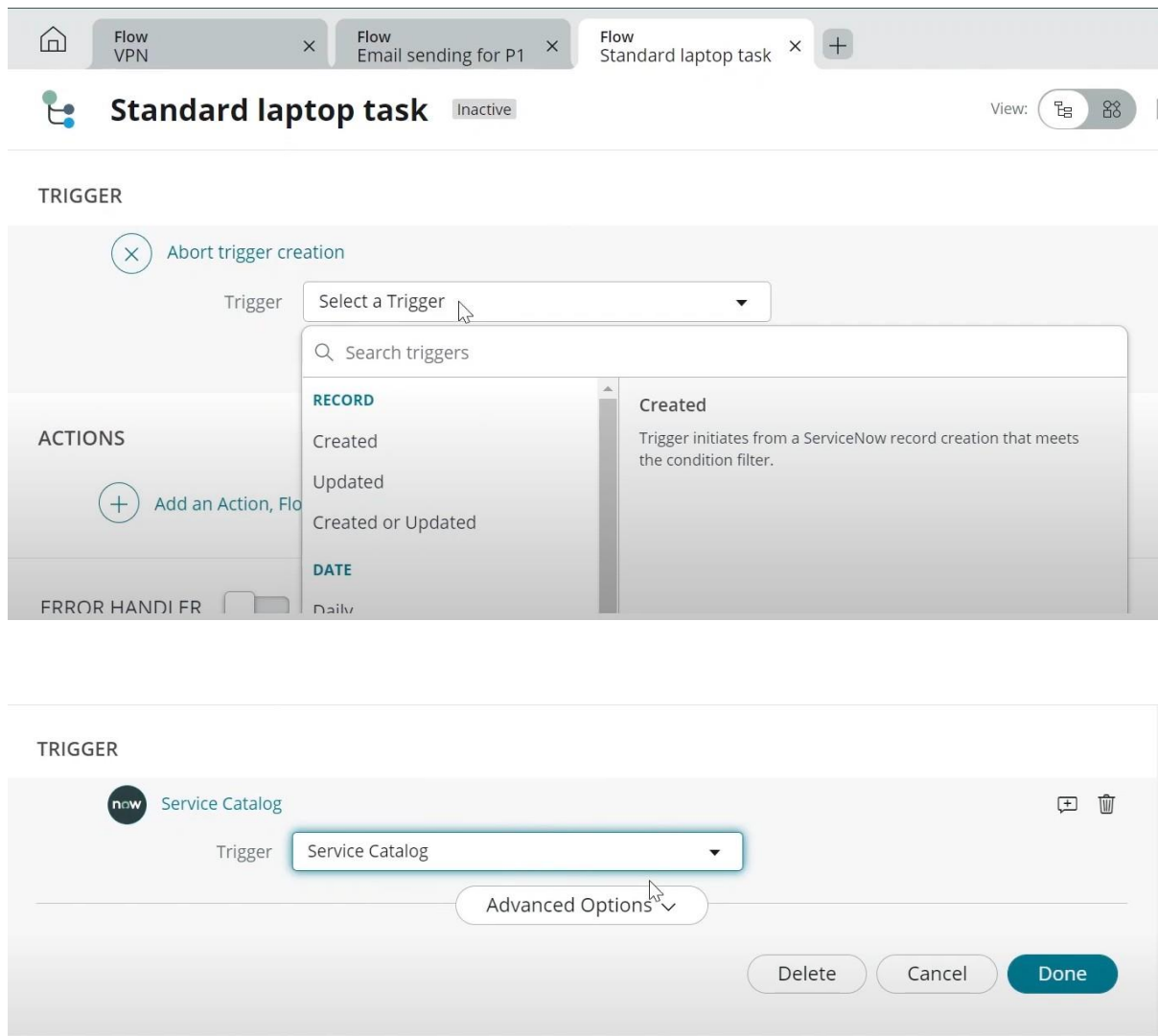
Application

Protection

Run As

Cancel Submit

1. Click on Add a trigger
2. Select the trigger in that Search for "Service Catalog" and select that.
3. After that click on Done.



1. Now under Actions.
2. Click on Add an action.
3. Select action in that search for "Create Catalog Task" and select that.
4. Mention these in that action
5. Action as Create Catalog Task
6. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
7. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
8. Mention the short description as "Laptop need to Configured".
9. Click on add field value
10. Select description field and value as "Laptop need to Configured".
11. Select Assignment group field and value as "Hardware".
12. Select Approval field and value as "Approved".
13. Leave there maintaining as default and click on Done.
14. Click on save the Flow.
15. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active



Action

Flow Logic

Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task

Most Recent

Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES

- ServiceNow Core
- Connect
- AES Portal UI Template
- Deployment Pipeline
- Virtual Agent
- Password Reset
- AES Flow Templates
- Global

Create Catalog Task

ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record

ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition

ServiceNow Core

Create Record

ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer

ServiceNow Core

Send Email

ServiceNow Core

Update Record

ServiceNow Core

Create Template ACL

ERROR HANDLING

If an error occurs



Standard Laptop task

Active

View:



Test

Deploy

1

Create Catalog Task



Action

Create Catalog Task

Table Name

Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]

Trigger - ... Requested Item ...

Short Description

Laptop needs to be configured

Fields

Description

Laptop needs to be configured

Assignment group

Hardware

Approval

Approved

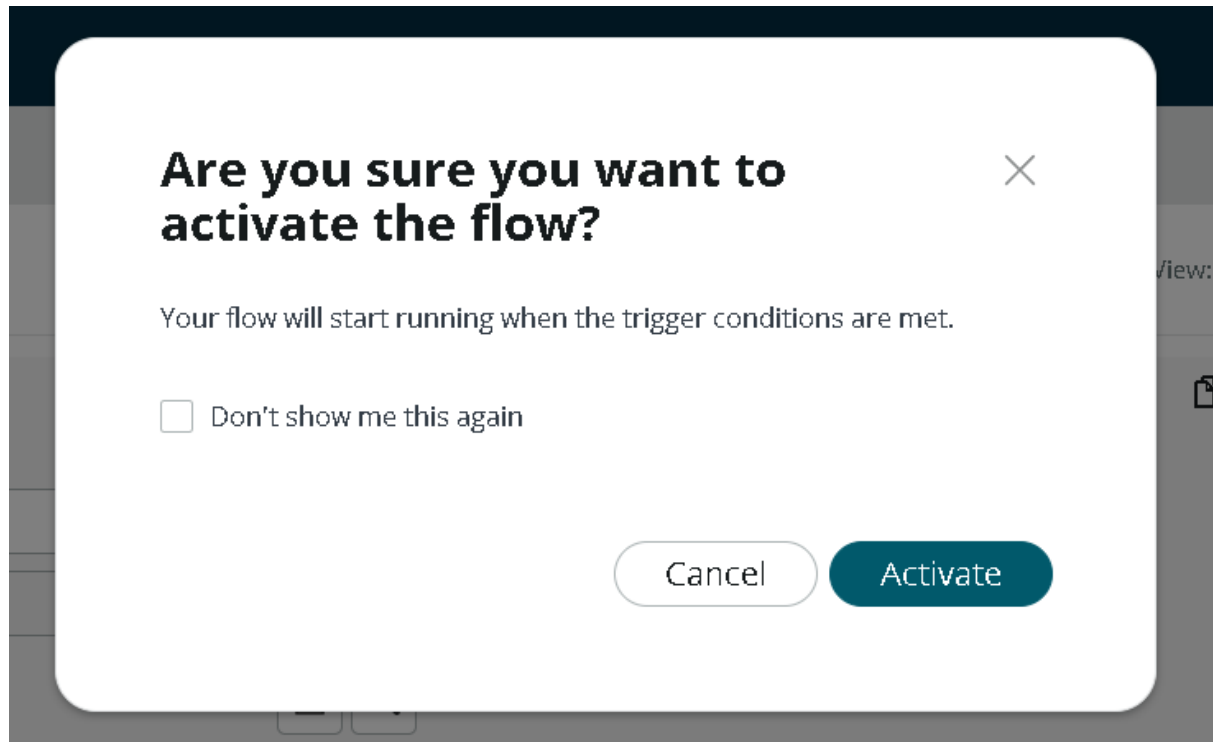
+ Add field value

Wait



Template Catalog

Create Template ACL



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 :

Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine.
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
standard	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	!=Package	Search
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

<

≡

Catalog Item

Standard Laptop

📎

⚙️

⋮

Update

Copy

Try It

Edit in Catalog Builder

De

Name

Standard Laptop

Application

Global

ⓘ

Catalogs

🔒

Service Catalog

Active

☒

Category

Hardware

🔍

ⓘ

Fulfillment automation level

Unspecified

▼

State

-- None --

Checked out

-- None --

Owner

🔍

Item Details

Process Engine

Picture

Pricing

Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog Item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow

Standard Laptop task

🔍

ⓘ

Workflow

🔍

Execution Plan

🔍

Update

Copy

Try It

Edit in Catalog Builder

Delete

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1:

Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “Service Catalog”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “Standard Laptop” click on that.
4. After that click on “Order Now” to place the request.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Standard Laptop

Search

Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

- ☐ Adobe Acrobat
- ☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

1

Subtotal

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery

Order Now0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#)

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17		₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Back to CatalogContinue Shopping

Home

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Request - REQ0010001

Search

Request REQ0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Short description

Special instructions

UpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Related Links

Show WorkflowWorkflow Context

Requested Items (1)Approvers (1)Recurring Prices (1)

State

Search

Actions on selected rows...

Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

1. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

[Update](#) | [Add New Item](#) | [Cancel Request](#) | [Copy](#) | [Delete](#)

Related Links

[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)		Prices (1)	
State	Approval for = REQ001	Approver	Comments
[icon] [filter icon]	Requester Eric Schroeder		

Created: 2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

2. Then click on the Requested item Section
3. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item RITM0010001 ☆

Search

< ≡ Requested Item RITM0010001

[Discuss] [Follow] [Update] [Delete]

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

- Impact: 3 - Low
- Opened by: System Administrator
- Priority: 4 - Low
- State: Open

[Update] [Delete]

Related Links

[Flow Context](#)

[Catalog Tasks \(1\)](#)
[Approvers](#)
[Group approvals](#)

≡ ▾ Number Search
 @ — Actions on selected rows... New

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

4. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks” Section
5. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a top navigation bar with buttons for Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The record details are organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (with a search icon), Configuration item (with a search icon), Active (checked), Short description (Laptop needs to Configured), Description (Laptop needs to Configured), and Worknotes (Work notes). The right column contains fields for Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). A Post button is located at the bottom right of the form. The bottom of the screen shows an Activities section with a filter icon.

Number	SCTASK0010001	Approval	Approved
Assigned to		Priority	4 - Low
Configuration item		State	Open
Active	☒	Request item	RITM0010001
Short description	Laptop needs to Configured	Requested for	System Administrator
Description	Laptop needs to Configured		
Worknotes	Work notes		

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow’s Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.